

Daily AI, Crypto & Tech Power Briefing

July 28, 2026

AI's Financing Test Meets China's Chip Challenge, While Crypto Trades Like a Risk Asset

The AI investment story faced a sharper market test today. Semiconductor shares fell across Asia as investors weighed high valuations, the cost of financing data-center expansion and stronger Chinese competition in memory chips.

Alphabet's latest results show the same tension at company level: cloud demand is growing quickly, but the price of keeping up is rising. In crypto, bitcoin fell alongside technology shares before the Federal Reserve decision, while Russia set a clearer framework for regulated digital-asset services.

1. The AI chip trade is being repriced around financing, competition and valuation

Reuters · July 28, 2026

Asian chip stocks slide as China competition fears rattle AI trade

The story

Asian semiconductor shares dropped sharply on Tuesday, led by South Korea, as investors reassessed the cost and financing of the AI buildout and the prospect of tougher Chinese competition. Reuters reported that CXMT's strong market debut added to concerns about competition in the global memory business.

This is not a verdict that AI demand has disappeared. It is a change in the question investors are asking: whether the returns

from data centers, chips and cloud capacity can justify the capital being committed, especially if more suppliers gain credible scale.

Why it matters

AI infrastructure has become a capital-intensive supply chain. A lower valuation multiple can quickly affect the economics of data-center projects, equipment orders and long-duration capacity commitments.

Chinese memory capacity matters because memory is a practical bottleneck for AI systems. More competition could reshape pricing power even if the highest-end products remain difficult to reproduce.

What to watch

- Earnings guidance from chipmakers and cloud companies on demand, pricing and inventory.
- Whether new Chinese supply reaches the specifications required for advanced AI workloads.
- How lenders and investors price large data-center commitments after the selloff.

2. Alphabet's cloud growth shows why AI capital expenditure now needs a return story

Reuters · July 22, 2026

Google increases capex forecast again after cloud-driven quarterly beat

The story

Alphabet reported its best quarterly growth for Google Cloud, Reuters said, but also raised its 2026 capital-spending plan by \$15 billion. Investors focused on the larger infrastructure commitment and on the timetable for the company's flagship AI model, even with cloud demand improving.

The result illustrates the new operating reality for large platforms. AI can lift cloud consumption and deepen customer relationships, yet the revenue arrives alongside major spending

on servers, networking, power and data centers.

Why it matters

Capital expenditure is becoming a measure of competitive position as well as cost. Companies that underinvest risk capacity constraints; companies that overinvest carry utilisation and cash-flow risk.

Investors are shifting from asking whether AI is useful to asking which services create enough recurring revenue and margin to support the infrastructure bill.

What to watch

- Cloud backlog, AI-product revenue and margin commentary in upcoming large-tech earnings.
- Whether capital-spending guidance is funded from operating cash flow, borrowing or alternative infrastructure financing.
- Signs that model releases or enterprise adoption convert capacity into durable demand.

3. Bitcoin's drop reinforces its sensitivity to technology risk and rate expectations

Investing.com · July 28, 2026

Bitcoin slips to 10-day low near \$63k as tech sell-off, Fed uncertainty weigh

The story

Bitcoin fell more than 3% toward \$63,000, its lowest level in ten days, as the selloff in AI-linked technology shares spread into crypto and traders prepared for the Federal Reserve's policy decision. Other major cryptoassets also declined, according to Investing.com.

The move is a useful reminder that the largest digital assets can trade as high-beta risk exposures in periods when investors are reducing technology and growth positions. Their long-term narratives do not remove short-term sensitivity to liquidity and rates.

Why it matters

A tighter or less predictable rate outlook raises the discount rate applied to long-duration assets. That can pressure both high-growth technology equities and crypto at the same time.

For institutions, correlation matters as much as a standalone price forecast. A portfolio that holds AI equities, crypto and venture exposure may be less diversified during a broad risk repricing than it appears.

What to watch

- The Federal Reserve decision and its guidance on inflation and future rates.
- Spot bitcoin exchange-traded fund flows after the risk-off move.
- Whether bitcoin stabilises independently of semiconductor and growth-stock performance.

4. Russia's new crypto rules put regulated intermediaries at the center of market access

Bank of Russia · July 21, 2026

[Russia introduces cryptocurrency regulation](#)

The story

The Bank of Russia said new cryptocurrency-market legislation will take effect on September 1, 2026. The framework establishes rules for crypto trading, custody and settlement, and sets an authorisation regime for professional market participants, with key requirements phasing in from July 2027.

The direction of travel is important: crypto access is being treated as a financial-market service with named intermediaries and operational responsibilities, not simply as a software feature. That makes custody, client onboarding and settlement design central to market credibility.

Why it matters

Regulatory clarity can expand institutional distribution, but it also concentrates responsibility in licensed providers. Their controls over client assets and transaction monitoring become part of the product itself.

A market framework is only as strong as its redemption mechanism, asset segregation and enforcement. Users need to distinguish access to a token from the legal and operational protections around it.

What to watch

- Which firms seek authorisation and what services they offer first.
 - The detailed custody standards, including private-key controls and client-asset segregation.
 - How the transition from September 2026 to the July 2027 intermediary requirements is supervised.
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Professional terms

capital expenditure - 资本支出	valuation multiple - 估值倍数
infrastructure financing - 基础设施融资	utilisation risk - 利用率风险
supply-chain bottleneck - 供应链瓶颈	memory bandwidth - 内存带宽
GPU (graphics processing unit) - 图形处理器	inference cost - 推理成本
cloud backlog - 云服务积压订单	operating cash flow - 经营现金流
discount rate - 贴现率	liquidity premium - 流动性溢价
risk correlation - 风险相关性	ETF (exchange-traded fund) - 交易型开放式指数基金
institutional distribution - 机构分销能力	custody risk - 托管风险
asset segregation - 资产隔离	settlement finality - 结算终局性
KYC (know your customer) - 了解你的客户	

Today's big picture

Today's big picture is that AI is entering a proof-of-economics phase. Strong demand still matters, but capital expenditure, financing terms and supply-chain competition now shape who captures the value.

Crypto remains connected to that broader financial cycle while its infrastructure becomes more regulated. The durable question is not only where an asset trades, but who holds it, settles it and bears the operational risk.